

FRAME//SHIFT

A FAST THREE-PANEL ACTION GAME ABOUT FIGHTING ACROSS TIME

THE CONCEPT

A time-space reactor has fractured one battle into three nearby moments: 10 minutes in the past, the present, and 10 minutes in the future. If it reaches critical overload, the fracture will cascade through spacetime. The player must fight through the split battle and shut the reactor down.

The three moments are shown together as comic panels, but the player controls only ONE panel at a time. The two inactive panels stay live and dangerous while running in heavy slow motion. Separately, the temporal roles have different native speeds: Past is slightly slower, Present is neutral, Future is slightly faster. At any moment the player can twist the timeline by reordering the live panels and choosing which one now counts as Past, Present or Future.

HOW THE THREE PANELS WORK



ACTIVE PANEL: full player control. **INACTIVE PANELS:** continue simulating in strong slow motion. Native time-flow speed and inactive-panel slowdown are two different systems. Twisting the timeline reassigns Past / Present / Future and immediately changes those rules.

COMBAT SYSTEM

FAST MELEE, MOBILITY & PARRY

Combat is light, fast and highly mobile: short melee strings, dash attacks, air-dashes and quick direction changes. There is no passive block-focused play. Parry is the central defensive skill: a successful parry stops an enemy attack, creates brief hit-stop, staggers the attacker and immediately gives the player initiative. Future movement information makes difficult parries learnable instead of purely reactive.

LAUNCH & AERIAL COMBAT

Launchers are not just combo spectacle - they create time. A heavy strike can pop an enemy airborne, letting the player leave that panel while the suspended fight continues in slowed time. The player can switch, fight elsewhere, then return before the target lands. Aerial combat stays short and mobile: launch -> jump / air-dash -> two or three air hits -> directional finisher.

LIGHT BEAM ATTACKS

Light beams are the only projectile attacks that cross panel time. They travel only forward: Past can fire into Present or Future; Present can fire into Future; Future cannot fire backward. Stationary future mirages help aim beams where enemies will be.

FUTURE INFORMATION

In Past, faint stationary future mirages reveal important later positions. In Future, enemies from earlier panels show ghosted movement traces of what they are about to do. The player can return and intercept, parry or attack the destination.

SWITCHING & TWIST

Switching is instant and can cancel recovery, so it is part of the combo system. Separately, the player can reorder the panels themselves. A fight can be twisted into Past to slow its native flow or into Future to expose movement traces and receive forward light.

PRESENTATION, ENEMIES & SCOPE

The entire experience is built around speed, readability and the feeling that the player is winning because they are literally fighting with information from another point in time.

VISUAL DESIGN



HI-FI RUSH - VISUAL REFERENCE

STYLE DIRECTION

The target is a stylized comic-action presentation rather than AAA fidelity. The visual reference is Hi-Fi Rush: cel-shaded materials, thick outlines, bold color separation, exaggerated silhouettes, clean telegraphs and punchy hit effects.

The comic structure is not decoration: panels resize and snap during switches, borders react to heavy impacts, and strong attacks use short hit-stop, camera punch, speed lines, slash trails and impact typography. The goal is immediate readability even when three fights are progressing at different rates.

ENEMY & ENCOUNTER DESIGN

MELEE GRUNT

Fast, readable close-range attacks. Teaches parry timing, launch and short aerial chains. Dies quickly so combat stays mobile.

GUNNER

Creates projectile pressure that remains dangerous even after the player leaves the panel. Projectiles can be dodged or parried back.

ASSASSIN / HEAVY

Assassins have fast movement that becomes easier to read from Future. Heavies resist simple launch attempts and reward parry or positional play first.

END GOAL & FINAL ENCOUNTER

The player is pushing toward the unstable reactor while combat escalates across all three panels. The final boss uses every rule at once: dangerous attacks continue in inactive panels, future movement traces reward foresight, light can be sent forward through time, and the player must keep switching to prevent any one fight from spiraling out of control. The climax is reaching the reactor and shutting it down before the time fracture becomes irreversible.

GAME REFERENCES & FEASIBILITY

GAME REFERENCES

Hi-Fi Rush - visual direction and hit readability. Furi - parry-centric duels. Boomerang X - aggressive movement and air mobility. Katana ZERO - anticipation and speed. FRAMED - comic panels used as game structure.

FEASIBILITY FOR THE 100-HOUR JAM

100-hour scope: one reused arena, three enemy types, one boss, one player, a small animation set, toon shading, comic UI/VFX and a browser build. Main risk: concurrent combat state. Only the active panel runs full simulation; inactive panels update slowly with simplified effects.

PROMPT JUSTIFICATION

Comic: the battlefield is a live three-panel comic page. Light: light beam attacks propagate only forward through temporal order. Twist: the player can reorder which live panel is Past, Present or Future, changing time flow, foresight and light propagation.